WEEK 10 · LECTURE L2 OF 3 · UNIT IV

Hybrid and Flexible Work

What the evidence supports, the equity trap of two-tier hybrid, and designing for GreenLeaf.

Part 1 Hybrid models and the evidence

Part 2 The equity trap: who can work hybrid at GreenLeaf

Part 3 Flexible employment and designing beyond the desk

Read Gratton (2021); Susskind (2020)

R K Singh · Senior Professor, Department of Commerce · Delhi School of Economics, University of Delhi · DSEH001 · M.Com. PGCF 2025

PART 1 · DESIGNING HYBRID

Two axes and four lenses (Gratton, 2021)

Place

From the office to anywhere.

Time

From fixed hours to any time (asynchronous).

Lens	The question
Jobs and tasks	Which tasks need co-location, focus, coordination or cooperation?
Employee preferences	What do people need and want?
Projects and workflows	Must the workflow be redesigned for hybrid?
Inclusion and fairness	Who is eligible, and who is structurally not?

WHERE DESIGNS FAIL The fourth lens.

PART 2 · THE EQUITY TRAP

Who can work hybrid at GreenLeaf?

33.6%

Corporate staff

33.6% of employees work in corporate departments; 79.5% of them have a laptop.

66.4%

Everyone else

In the other 66.4%, 73.3% depend on a phone alone, on fixed shifts.

THE TRAP

Hybrid offered only to desk staff creates two tiers: flexibility for some, fixed shifts and phone-only access for the rest. Source: Employee_Master, Department and Device_Access.

PART 3 · FLEXIBILITY BEYOND THE DESK

Three kinds of flexibility, and what the frontline can get

Kind	Examples	Possible for store and warehouse staff?
Temporal	Flextime, compressed weeks, shift swaps	Yes: app-based shift swaps and advance rosters
Spatial	Remote work, co-working	Rarely: the work is in the store
Contractual	Part-time, job sharing, phased retirement	Yes, with equal benefits pro rata

DESIGN RULE If place cannot flex, give control over time. ShiftPlan Scheduler (0.40 adoption) is the tool to build on.

Going deeper: the theory underneath hybrid work

The next slides set out Bloom's experiments, boundary theory, organizational justice in eligibility, and Susskind on task encroachment: what each claims, how it works, where it breaks, and what it means at GreenLeaf.

THEORY IN DEPTH · BLOOM ET AL. (2015, 2024)

What the experiments show

THE CORE IDEA

Bloom's 2015 randomized trial at a Chinese travel firm found full home working raised call-center performance by 13%.

HOW IT WORKS

A 2024 trial at the same firm found two home days a week cut quit rates by a third with no harm to performance or promotion.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

Results come from one firm and specific jobs; fully remote work has weaker evidence for collaboration.

AT GREENLEAF

Hybrid can be a cheap retention tool for corporate roles, where IT exit rates run at 33.3%.

THEORY IN DEPTH · ASHFORTH, KREINER AND FUGATE (2000)

People manage boundaries between work and home

THE CORE IDEA

Boundary theory: people segment or integrate their roles, and transitions between them cost effort.

HOW IT WORKS

Hybrid blurs boundaries; some people thrive on integration, others need segmentation.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

Individual preferences vary widely, so one policy rarely suits all.

AT GREENLEAF Let teams agree norms on availability, rather than imposing one rule for everyone.

THEORY IN DEPTH · GREENBERG (1987); COLQUITT (2001)

Eligibility decisions are judged on justice

THE CORE IDEA

Organizational justice has four forms: distributive, procedural, interpersonal and informational.

HOW IT WORKS

People accept unequal outcomes more readily when the process is fair and explained.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

Justice perceptions differ across cultures and status groups.

AT GREENLEAF

If store staff cannot have hybrid, explain why, and offer a fair equivalent such as shift control.

THEORY IN DEPTH · SUSSKIND (2020)

Machines take tasks, then more tasks

THE CORE IDEA

Task encroachment: technology takes over task after task, gradually shrinking human work.

HOW IT WORKS

Some workers are complemented today, but the set of tasks left for people keeps narrowing.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

Critics argue new tasks keep appearing, as in past waves of technology.

AT GREENLEAF

Warehouse Operator risk 0.81 and Store Associate 0.74: the task mix of these roles will change first.

TAKEAWAYS

Three things to carry out of this lecture

1

Design hybrid through all four lenses, especially fairness.

2

At GreenLeaf, hybrid by place reaches one third of staff.

3

Where place cannot flex, give people control over time.

NEXT Round 6: future-of-work strategy and the Board Memo.